Lane Brief 4 — India Coverage, Scope, Integration and Pitch

Owner: Sathvik Boina **Role:** Validation, integration and writing lead **Lane:** Part 4 of the one-week sprint **Dates:** Days 1–5 individual; Days 6–7 shared merge and review **Branch:** `feat/india-scope-docs`

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1. Your mission in one paragraph

Close the India question with downloaded data or a recorded access failure, keep the project's scope and claim wording honest, and **coordinate** the Day 6 merge and Day 7 go/no-go. You are the integration owner, not the owner of every check: Arshiya runs the combined clean clone, Palchhin owns the results docs, Shravani owns the label docs, and each lane owner merges their own branch. Your job is to make the pieces fit, write the plain-English story, and stop the project from overclaiming.

2. What has already happened (so you do not repeat it)

- **The USA label is frozen as `labels-v3`.** 1990Q1–2026Q3 (147 quarters), 4/4 NBER recessions, zero false episodes, accuracy 0.993, precision 0.929, recall 1.000, F1 0.963. `labels-v1` and `labels-v2` are archived byte-identically.
- **The 2026 extension is done and verified.** The panel and reporting window moved from 2025Q4 to 2026Q3 without changing the estimator, BBQ, diffusion gate or eight-indicator structure.
- **India is already pre-audited.** The best case is **4/8** core indicators, so under O-2 India stays **Label-B-only**. The 6-of-8 rule is not relaxed. This lane exists to replace the pre-audit with actual download evidence, or to record why access failed.
- **The ensemble is pre-registered.** Equal-weight top-3 by inner-fold pooled PR-AUC, a ≥0.01 absolute gain, a bootstrap CI excluding zero, and no episode-recall loss. It is applied once. A negative result is reported.
- **The first model result is USA-first.** Japan and Germany join only if their labels pass and time allows. Do not delay the USA headline for a country label.
- **The whole-repository review is complete.** 38 tests pass; `make check` gives 33 ok, 3 warnings (optional model packages), 0 failures; `build.py` reproduces all 13 root CSVs byte-for-byte; workbook cell diff is 0; frozen hashes unchanged. A fresh clone shows 36 passed and 2 explicit skips until the git-ignored `data/clean` is rebuilt.
- **No feature table, folds, model or out-of-sample score exists yet.** That is what Parts 2 and 3 build during the week.
- **Nothing is packaged, mirrored, zipped or tagged.** Day 7 packaging requires explicit approval; the default is to write findings instead.

Read first: `docs/TEAM_PLAN.md`, `docs/STATE.md`, `docs/BUILD_CONTRACT.md`, `docs/PROPOSAL_ADDENDUM.md`, `docs/INDIA_COVERAGE_AUDIT.md`, `docs/DECISIONS.md`, `docs/VERIFICATION.md`, `README.md`.

3. What you own: Days 1–5

Day	Task	Output	Done when
1	Download the candidate MoSPI/RBI India series, or record the exact access failure	`data/india_core_coverage.csv`	Every India core row has a downloaded-data status or a recorded failure; no proxy substituted
2	Close the India verdict: confirm the business/non-residential GFCF split and the official retail series; recompute 6/8	Final India count and note	Count recorded (or access failure); O-2 stays Label-B-only; pre-audit 4/8 stays provisional if downloads fail
3	Audit the 2026 extension and sync docs **with Shravani and Palchhin**	Updated `README.md`, `docs/STATE.md`, `docs/VERIFICATION.md`, claim wording	Docs agree with `labels-v3`; no unsupported forecast claim; label docs and results docs cross-checked
4	Review Arshiya's dry-run clean clone of current `main` and the packaging checklist	Review note and checklist	Current `main` passes; nothing packaged or tagged; the combined clean clone is explicitly Day 7
5	Run the integration rehearsal with all four and write the plain-English pitch	Rehearsal notes, one-page pitch	Merge order works; pitch says what the label proves and what the model result does not prove

Suggested daily rhythm

- **09:30 — 15-minute stand-up.** You facilitate, but each owner reports their own work.
- **Keep a decisions log.** If the team changes a rule before results, record the date and the reason; after results, do not rewrite history.
- **17:30 — integration note.** What merged cleanly, what is still open, and who owns it.
- **Day 6:** coordinate the merge in the fixed order; each owner merges their own branch. **Day 7:** coordinate cross-review and the go/no-go with Arshiya.

4. What we expect by Day 5

A complete Part 4 hand-off contains:

1. **India coverage table.** `data/india_core_coverage.csv` with a real status for every core row: downloaded, access-blocked, or not published. No proxy and no guess.
2. **India verdict.** Final 6/8 count or a recorded access failure; O-2 stays Label-B-only; the pre-audit 4/8 remains labelled provisional if downloads fail.
3. **Consistent docs.** `README.md`, `docs/STATE.md`, `docs/VERIFICATION.md` and the claim wording agree with `labels-v3` and the 147-quarter window. Shravani has checked the label docs and Palchhin the results docs.
4. **Dry-run evidence.** Arshiya's clean clone of current `main` is recorded; the packaging checklist is complete; nothing is bundled, mirrored, zipped or tagged.

5. **Integration rehearsal.** The fixed merge order has been tried once; each owner knows which branch they merge and which checks follow.
6. **Plain-English pitch.** One page: what was built, what the label proves, what the model result does not prove, and what is next. No forecast claim before out-of-sample results.
7. **A PR on `feat/india-scope-docs`** with commands, tests, hashes and known gaps.

How your lane is judged

- **Scope gate:** India is Label-B-only under O-2; the 6-of-8 rule is unchanged; no country is quietly promoted.
- **Claim gate:** no forecast claim before out-of-sample results; caveats present; the negative-result path is described honestly.
- **Integration gate:** the merge order works, each owner merges their own branch, and no check is silently skipped.
- **Release gate:** nothing is packaged, mirrored, zipped or tagged without explicit approval.
- **Work balance:** you coordinate rather than absorb. If a lane is behind, the owner says so and the team re-plans; you do not quietly finish it yourself.

5. How your work combines with the others

Hand-off	When	What must be true
H1: you → all	Day 1 morning	Everyone can state their Day 1 task from `docs/team/` and `docs/TEAM_PLAN.md`
H3: Shravani → you	Day 5 end	Japan label + chronology note + Germany 6/8 decision; hashes recorded
H4: Arshiya → Palchhin + you	Day 4 end (final folds); Day 5 end (frozen)	Table + final folds available for the USA headline; frozen files and leakage tests complete
H5: Palchhin → you	Day 5 end	USA headline, episode, ablation and ensemble tables; C-13 applied once
H6: all → you + Arshiya	Day 6 morning	One branch per lane, green checks, short hand-off note
Day 6 merge	Steps 1–4	Shravani merges labels, Arshiya features/folds, Palchhin models, you docs; checks after each
Day 7 review	—	Cross-review, combined clean clone (Arshiya runs, you record), then go/no-go
H7: you + Arshiya → all	Day 7 morning	Clean-clone evidence, hash table, draft go/no-go

Your lane is the glue. You do not need to be the best at labels, features or models; you need the whole thing to be consistent, reproducible and honestly described.

6. DOs

- **DO** read the four lane briefs and the team plan before Day 1.
- **DO** record an access failure exactly; a blocked download is evidence, not a reason to invent a proxy.
- **DO** keep India Label-B-only under O-2 and keep the 6-of-8 rule unchanged.

- **DO** delegate verification: Arshiya owns the combined clean clone, Palchhin the results docs, Shravani the label docs.
- **DO** let each lane owner merge their own branch in the fixed order.
- **DO** run the checks after every merge and write down the result.
- **DO** keep the pitch plain: what was built, what it proves, what it does not prove.
- **DO** record every rule change before results, with a date and a reason.
- **DO** ask for help early and escalate a slipping lane at the stand-up.
- **DO** keep the final package behind explicit approval.

7. DON'Ts

- **DON'T** absorb another lane's unfinished work silently. Coordinate, re-plan, or record the gap.
- **DON'T** relax the 6-of-8 rule, O-2 or the ensemble rule to make the story cleaner.
- **DON'T** substitute a proxy for missing India data or present the pre-audit as final.
- **DON'T** claim a forecast before out-of-sample results exist.
- **DON'T** change a frozen label, a fold boundary, the estimator or the eight-indicator structure without a new version and a recorded decision.
- **DON'T** create a bundle, mirror, zip or release tag without explicit approval.
- **DON'T** hand-edit generated artefacts; regenerate them.
- **DON'T** merge a red branch or hide a failed check.
- **DON'T** let the Day 4 dry run stand in for the Day 7 combined clean clone.

8. Allowed creative liberty and educational freedom

Inside the guardrails, you have room to make the project better:

- **Choose the pitch format.** A one-pager, a short slide deck, a narrative README section or a spoken walkthrough are all fine; keep the claims accurate.
- **Add useful extras.** An India source table, a decision timeline, a glossary, a "what we learned" page or a short integration checklist are welcome.
- **Learn while you work.** You may spend up to about half a day (roughly 10% of the lane) on integration tooling, reproducibility, writing or a scope question. Note it in your hand-off.
- **Improve the integration process** — a cleaner merge checklist, a hash table, a one-command verification script — as long as the checks themselves do not weaken.
- **Propose a scope improvement** before results if you think it is defensible. The team decides and records it; it does not become a silent exception.
- **Write a "what I learned" section** in the final note. It helps the next cohort.

9. If you get stuck

1. **India access is blocked?** Record the exact failure, the URL and the date, then stop. A documented failure is the deliverable.
2. **A lane slips?** Say so at the stand-up and re-plan the Day 5 hand-off. Do not hide it until Day 6.
3. **Docs disagree?** Find the single source of truth (`config/scope.yaml`, `labels-v3`, the frozen hashes) and fix the prose to match it.
4. **A merge turns red?** Stop; the owner fixes their branch before the next merge. Do not patch around it on `main`.

5. **Someone asks for a package?** Confirm explicit approval first, then follow the packaging checklist. Otherwise write findings and next actions.

10. Where to look

Need	File
The plan	`docs/TEAM_PLAN.md`, `Team_Plan.xlsx`
Current state and hashes	`docs/STATE.md`
Frozen rules	`docs/BUILD_CONTRACT.md`
Ensemble and claim wording	`docs/PROPOSAL_ADDENDUM.md`
India pre-audit	`docs/INDIA_COVERAGE_AUDIT.md`
Decisions	`docs/DECISIONS.md`, `decisions_log.csv`
Verification evidence	`docs/VERIFICATION.md`
Lane briefs	`docs/team/01_shravani_japan_germany.md`, `02_arshiya_features_harness.md`, `03_palchhin_models_ensemble.md`
Weekly log	`EWS_Work_Log.xlsx`
Scope and sources	`config/scope.yaml`, `data/scope.csv`

Bottom line: close India honestly, keep the scope and the words precise, and coordinate a merge where each owner carries their own lane. A documented access failure and a clean go/no-go are successful outcomes; an overclaimed package is not.